

Skills

Obtaining Blood Pressure by the One-Step Method

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Checked patient's baseline reading, determined best site for use.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Positioned patient and patient's arm appropriately.	☐	☐	☐	
Exposed upper arm fully, did not place BP cuff over clothing.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured blood pressure cuff was the appropriate size.	☐	☐	☐	
Palpated patient's brachial artery in the antecubital space.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied BP cuff. Positioned cuff properly above artery, wrapped fully deflated cuff properly around upper arm.	☐	☐	☐	

Positioned manometer properly, stood no more than one yard away from it. ☐ ☐ ☐

Cleaned earpieces, diaphragm, and bell of stethoscope with alcohol swabs. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed earpieces in ears, ensured sounds were clear and not muffled. ☐ ☐ ☐

Asked patient not to speak while BP is measured. ☐ ☐ ☐

Located the brachial or radial artery appropriately and placed either the bell or the diaphragm of the stethoscope over it below the bottom of the cuff. Did not let the chest piece touch the cuff or clothing. Did not place the diaphragm under the cuff or place excessive pressure on the stethoscope head. ☐ ☐ ☐

Turned valve on pressure bulb clockwise until tight, inflated cuff properly above patient's usual systolic pressure. ☐ ☐ ☐

Released pressure valve slowly, let manometer indicator fall appropriately, observed point at which first Korotkoff sound was heard. ☐ ☐ ☐

Deflated cuff slowly, noted pressure where all Korotkoff sounds disappeared. ☐ ☐ ☐

Listened appropriately after last sound, quickly let remaining air escape. ☐ ☐ ☐

Took blood pressure again in 2 minutes, used second set of measurements as baseline. ☐ ☐ ☐

If this was the patient's first BP assessment, repeated the procedure on the other arm. If there was a consistent difference between the blood pressure in the patient's arms, used the arm with the higher pressure. ☐ ☐ ☐

Helped patient to comfortable position, returned any removed clothing, discussed findings with patient, reported any abnormal values. ☐ ☐ ☐

Cleaned the BP cuff per the manufacturer's instructions and the organization's practice. Cleaned the earpieces and diaphragm of the stethoscope, if applicable, per the organization's practice. Placed toiletries and personal items within reach. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed call light within easy reach, ensured patient knew how to use it. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised side rails and lowered bed to ensure patient safety. ☐ ☐ ☐

Disposed of used supplies and equipment, left patient's room tidy.

☐☐☐

Removed and disposed of gloves when worn, performed hand hygiene.

☐☐☐

Compared findings with appropriate classification of blood pressure.

☐☐☐

Taught patient ways to prevent hypertension.

☐☐☐

Documented and reported patient's response and outcomes.

☐☐☐

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____